



Holiday Fraud

With more of us doing our holiday shopping online, we should be alert to the increase in scams around this time. Scammers specifically use the holiday season to target shoppers through cyber crime.

According to AARP, over 80% of adults in America have been exposed to cyber scams during the holiday season.



Additional Resources

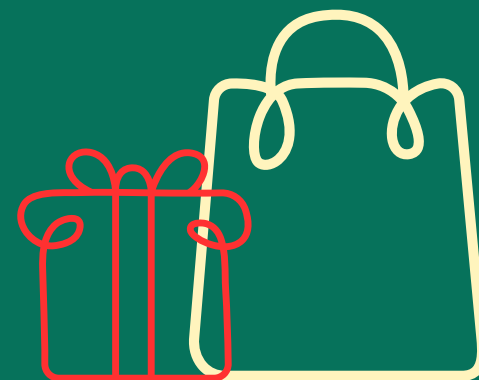
Check the **Better Business Bureau** for website legitimacy.

Contact the **AARP Fraud Watch Network Hotline** at **877-908-3360** to speak to a trained fraud specialist.

Attend an **IRS webinar** for more information on scams during **National Tax Security Awareness Week**

Stay up to date with your **local news** for common scams in your area.

Marissa Miller



Tips For Safe Online Holiday Shopping

Common Scams

Fake websites created to impersonate legitimate websites with the intention to steal payments and personal information.

Gift cards scams involve fraudsters posing as individuals, retailers, or organizations asking for gift card purchasers to share card numbers and pins.

Delivery Scams involve notifications from scammers posing as delivery services that are having issues delivering a package. They contain links aimed to steal log-ins and personal information.

Fake charities closely resemble legitimate causes asking for donations in suspicious forms like untraceable payment portals or gift cards.



7 Tips to Help Prevent Online Fraud

Protect your devices by updating them regularly.

Use safe wifi connections.

Create unique, strong passwords.

Shop on trusted websites.

Be wary of clicking on unfamiliar and suspicious links.

Use credit cards to make purchases when possible.

Keep on eye on your financial statements during the holiday season.

Reporting Fraud

Cyber criminals have gotten increasingly better at targeting holiday shoppers. If you fall victim to a cyber crime, you are not alone. Below are a few things you can do if you become a victim of fraud.

Contact your **attorney general** to file a claim.

Reach out to your **financial institution** to dispute any fraudulent charges and secure your accounts.

Report scammers to the **FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center**.